

FILM DOSSIER: IRON MAN 2

Phase 1 · Film #5

Status: ☒ DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	5 of 29
Phase	Phase 1
Real title	<i>IRON MAN 2</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"RABBIT HOLE"</i>
Release date	Friday, May 7, 2010
Distributor	Paramount Pictures
Director	Jon Favreau
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 158 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + addiction drama / espionage thriller

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (Iron Man, film 2 of the franchise)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Marc-Anthony Bullock	28
Pepper Potts	Tayia Boyd	28
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow	Harmony Divine	27
Claire Barton / Hawkeye	Arianna Cummings	27
James "Rhodey" Rhodes	Don Cheadle	45
The Mandarin	Tony Leung	47
Justin Hammer	Sam Rockwell	41
Happy Hogan	Jon Favreau	43
Nick Fury	Samuel L. Jackson	61
Agent Jasper Sitwell	Maximiliano Hernández	36
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a Coney Island barker</i>)	Stan Lee	87

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>"Demon in a Bottle"</i> , <i>Iron Man</i> #120–128 (1979), David Michelinie, Bob Layton & John Romita Jr.: Tony's alcoholism, Justin Hammer's sabotage, and the armor killing a diplomat. <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #50 (February 1964): the Mandarin .
Supporting comics	<i>Tales of Suspense</i> #52 (April 1964): the Black Widow's first appearance, as a Soviet spy against Iron Man · <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #57 (September 1964): Hawkeye's first appearance. After a misunderstanding at a carnival, the Widow tricks Hawkeye into fighting Iron Man. · <i>Iron Man</i> #169–170 (1983): Rhodey puts on the Iron Man armor · <i>Tales of Suspense</i> #62 (1965, the Mandarin's origin and the Makluan rings)
Nerf check	✅ The Mandarin is one of the most powerful villains Iron Man has. All ten rings work at full comic strength, and Tony can't win on his own.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	95%. It combines four landmark storylines. The main change is timing: the Widow and Hawkeye's debut (1964) is paired with "Demon in a Bottle" (1979), and the villains' plots are woven together.

Straight from the page:

- **"Demon in a Bottle"**: Tony's drinking spirals. **Justin Hammer** remotely takes over the armor, and **it fires on and kills the ambassador of Carnelia** in public. Tony is disgraced, loses control of his company, and hits bottom. He **gets sober by his own choice**.
- **Justin Hammer**: a smooth, jealous rival arms industrialist (*Iron Man* #120).
- **The Mandarin**: a Chinese genius and martial-arts master who found **ten alien rings** in the wreck of a **Makluan starship** in the **Valley of Spirits** (*ToS* #50, #62).
- **The Black Widow**: a Soviet spy sent to steal Stark technology, seductive, deadly and a master of disguise. On 616 she was trained in the **Red Room** (the later 616 version), and she's a ballet dancer.
- **Hawkeye: Claire Barton**, a carnival sharpshooter raised in **the circus**, sees Iron Man in action at **Coney Island** and decides to become a hero. On her first night out she's **mistaken for a thief**, and **the Black Widow** takes advantage of that and recruits her against Iron Man (*ToS* #57).
- **Rhodey in the armor**: while Tony is out of action, **Rhodey wears the Iron Man armor** in combat (*Iron Man* #169–170). ("Next time, baby" pays off.)
- **The attaché-case armor**: Tony carries a portable armor in a briefcase (Silver Age).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Widow and Hawkeye (1964) appear in the same film as "Demon in a Bottle" (1979) | Sliding timescale. It gets both of them established before *The Avengers*, and the Widow's manipulation of Tony adds to his crisis. |

| Hammer and the Mandarin work together | In 616 they were separate threats. Here Hammer is the Mandarin's Western supplier, so the two plots become one. |

| Carnelia's ambassador's death is shown off-screen | PG-13 |

| Hawkeye is Claire Barton | Per the Casting Rules. **She's always been Claire**. Nothing else changes. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Iron Man (Mark IV)	Repulsors; uni-beam; supersonic flight; multi-ton strength; sensors; the attaché-case armor (Silver Age)	All of it, including Tony suiting up from the briefcase in a Monaco hotel corridor	Later-generation armors (as the comics' models advance)	✓ 100%
Tony Stark	Genius; his addiction is a weakness from the comics, not a nerf	Designs the Mark IV hungover; sober at the finale	–	✓ 100%
The Mandarin	Ten Makluan rings: ice blast, mento-intensifier (mind control), electro-blast, flame blast, white light, black light (darkness), disintegration beam, vortex beam, matter rearranger, impact beam. Master martial artist who can shatter iron by hand. Genius-level scientist. (<i>ToS</i> #50, #62)	All ten rings are used on screen (each gets a moment), plus hand-to-hand fights where he breaks Iron Man's gauntlet bare-handed	–	✓ 100%. It takes Iron Man, Rhodey, and a turned Hawkeye together to force him to retreat. He escapes, as he always does in the comics.
Justin Hammer	Criminal industrialist; hacking and remote-control engineering	Remotely hijacks Tony's armor	–	✓ 100%
The Black Widow	Peak-human conditioning (the Red Room program); master spy, martial artist, markswoman and seductress; "Widow's Bite" gauntlet stings; wall-crawling suction and a grapple line (<i>ToS</i> #52 on)	All of it: she infiltrates Stark Industries as a new executive, fights a Hammer strike team, and uses the Widow's Bite	–	✓ 100%
Hawkeye (Claire Barton)	The world's greatest marksman. Peak-human accuracy and reflexes; acrobat; trick arrows: explosive, net, grappling, acid, suction, smoke, electric, sonic (<i>ToS</i> #57)	Every trick arrow on the list. She never misses once in the film, including a shot that splits a thrown knife in midair.	Her Avengers role (Phase 2)	✓ 100%
Rhodey (in armor)	Elite Marine pilot and soldier; fully effective in the armor (<i>Iron Man</i> #170)	Fights the Mandarin's forces in the Mark III	His own War Machine armor (616, 1992; Phase 2)	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	Tony Stark tells the world he's Iron Man, and it nearly kills him. A rival sabotages his armor, a spy works her way into his life, an ancient warlord comes for his technology, and his worst enemy is the bottle.
Theme	Addiction and recovery. The strongest armor in the world can't protect you from yourself.
Villain / antagonist	The Mandarin (main), Justin Hammer , and the Black Widow and Hawkeye (at first)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE PRICE OF "I AM IRON MAN"

- **January 2010.** Tony is the most famous man on Earth and falling apart. He's drinking hard and being hauled in front of the Senate, and **Justin Hammer** is testifying against him.
- A striking new executive assistant joins Stark Industries under a cover name. She's **Natasha Romanoff**, the Black Widow, a Soviet-trained spy sent to steal the repulsor designs.
- **Monaco:** Tony suits up from his **attaché-case armor** to stop a Hammer-financed attack at the Grand Prix.

ACT TWO: DEMON IN A BOTTLE

- At a United Nations reception, Hammer's hackers **seize control of the armor**. It fires, and **the ambassador of Carnelia is killed**.
- Tony is disgraced. The board forces him out, and the drinking gets much worse.
- **Pepper** tells him the truth. **Rhodey** takes the Mark III: *"Next time, baby."* This is the next time.
- On **Coney Island**, circus sharpshooter **Claire Barton** stops a robbery, is mistaken for the thief, and runs. The **Widow** is waiting for her with an offer and a lie: *Iron Man is the real criminal*.
- The Widow and Hawkeye attack Tony at his lowest point. **Hawkeye's arrows** take the Mark IV apart.
- The Widow reports to her handler, whose voice on the phone is calm and sounds almost amused. It's **the Mandarin**.

ACT THREE: THE TEN RINGS

- Hammer has been **supplying the Mandarin**, who wants Tony's armor technology to bring back his ancient Makluan starship.
- Tony wakes up on a hotel bathroom floor. Pepper is sitting next to him, and he **pours the bottle out**. Day one.
- **The Valley of Spirits, China.** Tony (in a new Mark IV), **Rhodey** (in the Mark III) and **Hawkeye**, who has worked out she was lied to, take on **the Mandarin**.
- All ten rings are in use. The Mandarin is winning.
- **The Widow makes her choice:** she sabotages the Makluan starship's power core from inside.
- The Mandarin **retreats into the mountains**, alive, as he always does.
- Hammer is arrested. The Widow and Hawkeye **disappear** together before S.H.I.E.L.D. arrives.

- Tony gets his company back. The last shot is him at an AA meeting in a church basement: *"My name is Tony. It's been thirty-one days."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, January 11, 2010 (the Senate) → Friday, April 16, 2010 (the AA meeting). The post-credit scene is on Sunday, April 18, 2010 .
Where it's set	Washington, D.C. · Monaco · New York City (UN headquarters, 890 Fifth Avenue, Coney Island) · the Valley of Spirits, China (filmed in Zhangjiajie, Hunan)
Relative to other films	Five months after <i>Ant-Man and the Wasp</i> . Tony tells Pepper <i>"Pym's still ignoring my calls."</i>

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Stark after the reveal:** the public hero, the Senate, the rivals.
- **The Mandarin and the Makluan rings**, Iron Man's archenemy.
- **Tony's sobriety**, carried forward for the rest of the saga.
- **Rhodey in armor**, the start of his path to War Machine.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Black Widow & Hawkeye	Their debut, as antagonists who switch sides and then vanish	Phase 2: Hawkeye joins "Cap's Kooky Quartet" (<i>Avengers</i> #16) and the Widow defects
The Red Room	The Widow's handler file shows a ballet studio in Moscow.	The Widow's Phase 2 story
S.H.I.E.L.D.	Sitwell arrives at the Valley of Spirits too late. Fury is angry.	<i>The Avengers</i>
The Avengers Initiative	Fury gives Tony a file with a Hulk sighting, Blake's hospital file, and a photo of a dollhouse. Tony: " <i>What is this, a book club?</i> "	<i>The Avengers</i>
Captain America	The post-credit scene	<i>Captain America</i> (2011)

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
The first mention of the Infinity Gems	Defeated in the mountains, the Mandarin looks at his rings: " <i>Ten rings. Ten lesser stars. The Makluans told of six jewels older than creation, and a Titan who hunts them. When I find the first, even he will kneel.</i> "	The first time the Infinity Gems are mentioned in the MCU, and the Titan is hunting them.
The pattern	Titan (<i>Iron Man</i>), Titan (<i>Hulk</i>), Titan (<i>Thor</i>), the golden helmet (<i>Ant-Man</i>), and now the jewels	Fans start building the timeline on forums.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	 "THE ARCHER." On a S.H.I.E.L.D. Helicarrier, Fury watches security footage from the Valley of Spirits. Claire Barton puts an arrow through a gap in the Mandarin's energy shield half an inch wide. FURY: <i>"Get me the archer."</i> SITWELL: <i>"And the Widow?"</i> FURY: <i>"The Widow will come to us."</i>
Post-credit scene	 "STILL LOOKING." Fury's private office, at night. A framed WWII photograph : a young Sgt. Nick Fury with the Howling Commandos , and in the middle, a young man with a star on his chest and a round shield . Fury studies it, then looks at a map of the North Atlantic covered in crossed-off search grids. FURY (quietly): <i>"Sixty-five years, Cap. I'm still looking."</i> CUT TO BLACK.
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "SECURITY REVIEW." Post-credit: "FAMILY PHOTO."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline